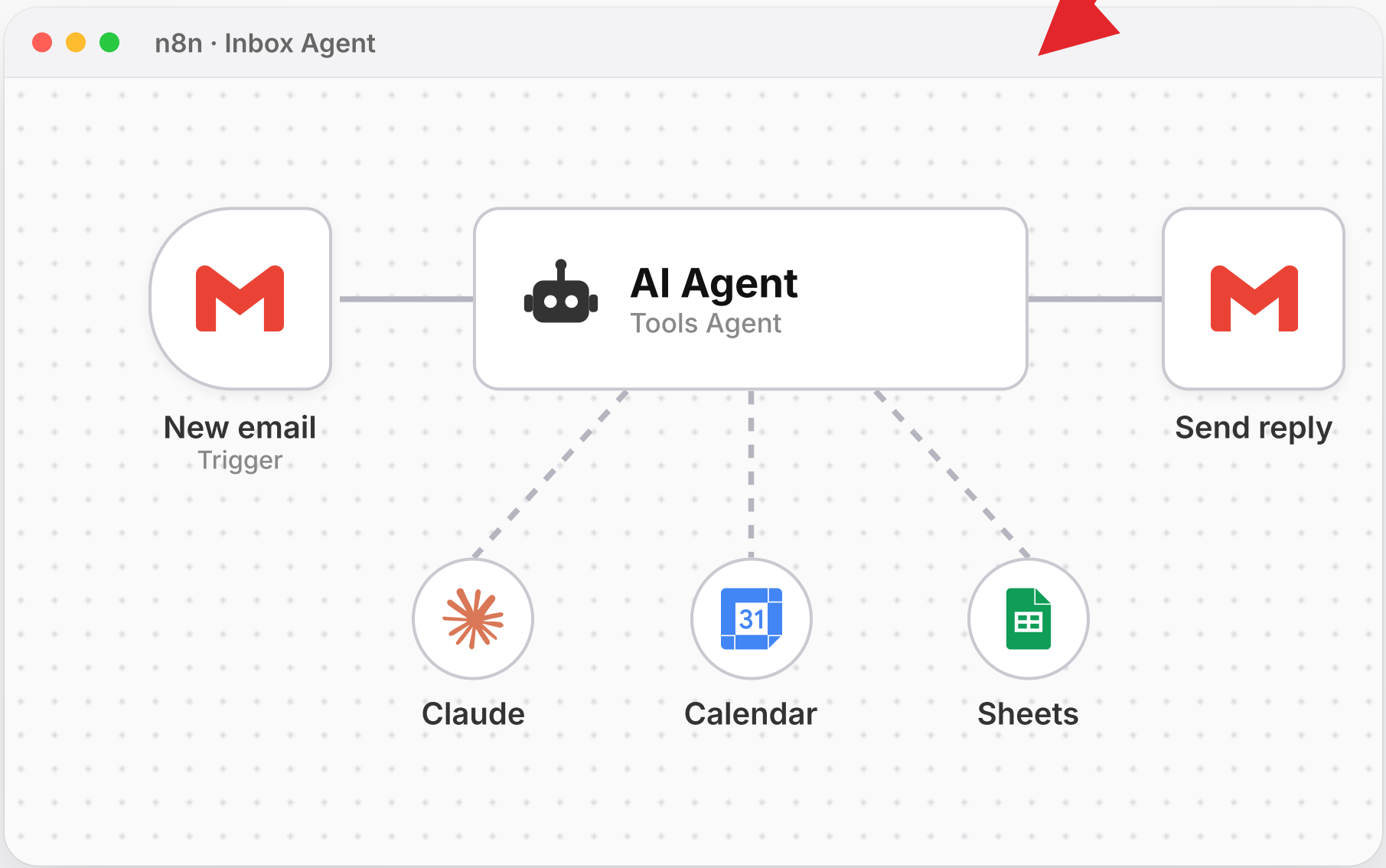
How to Build Your

1st AI Agent

it reads, decides
& replies for you

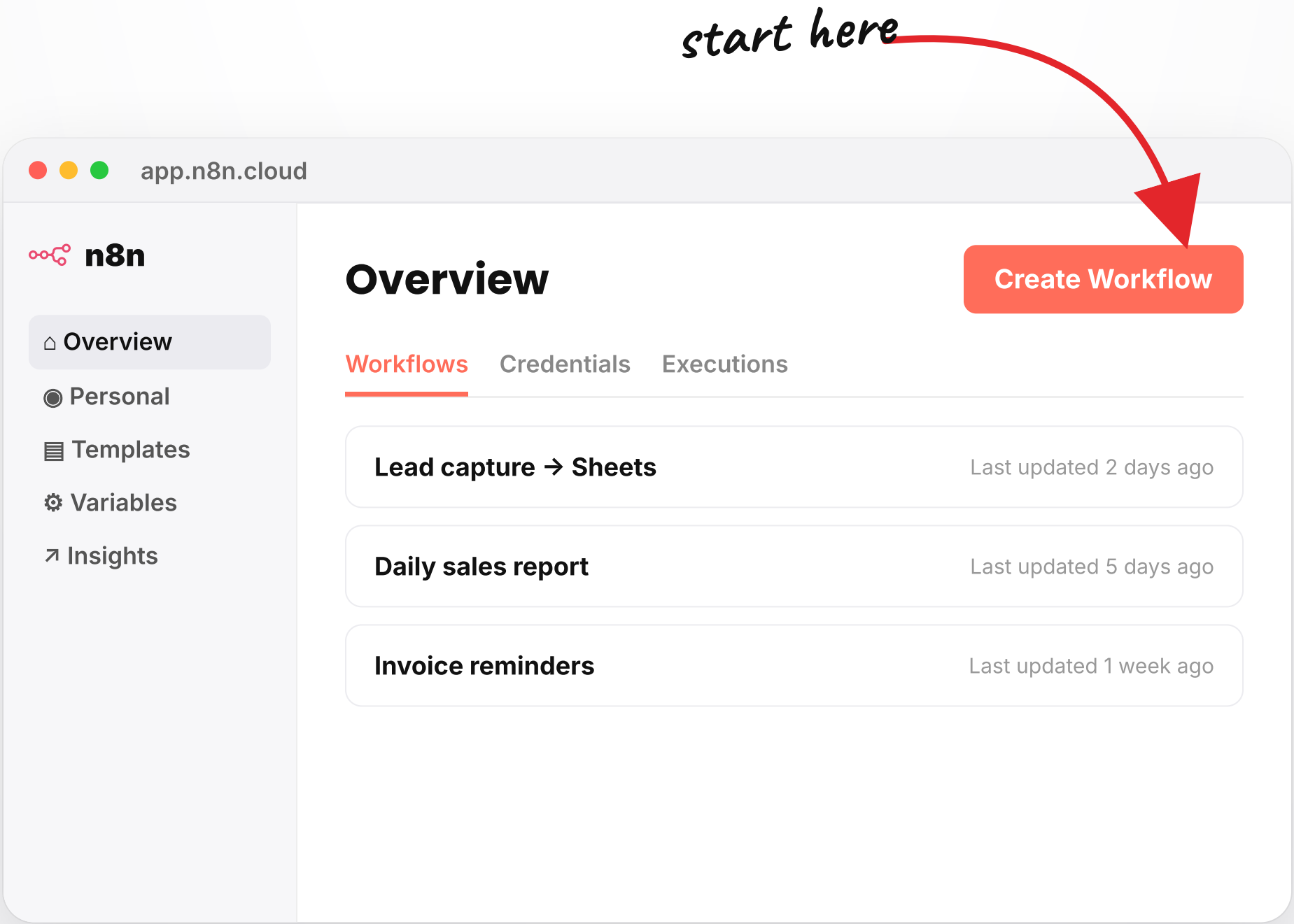


Swipe →

Step 1

Create a New Workflow in n8n

Cloud or self-hosted, both work. Click **Create Workflow**.

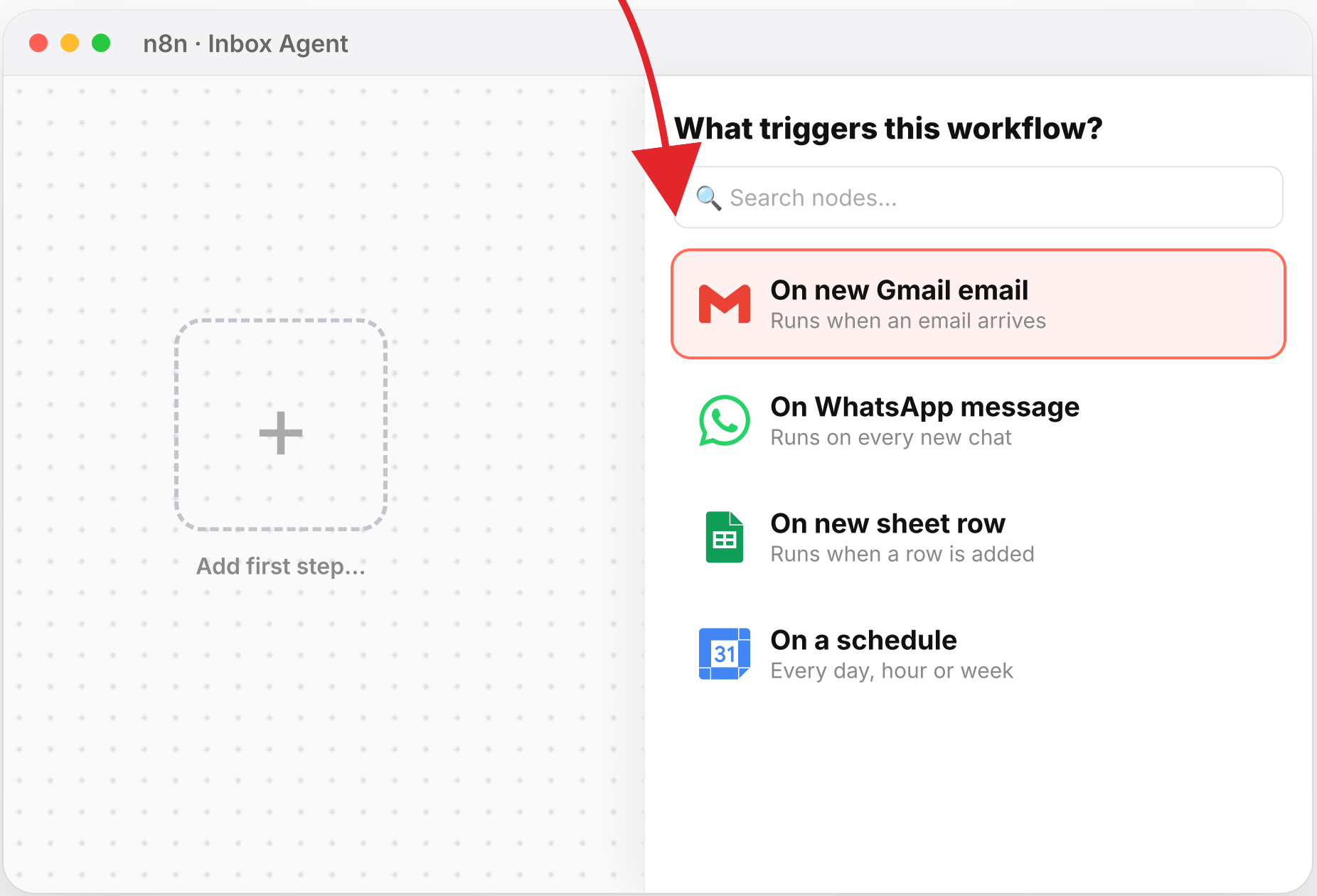


Step 2

Add a Trigger

The trigger decides **when** your agent wakes up. We'll use new emails.

pick your trigger

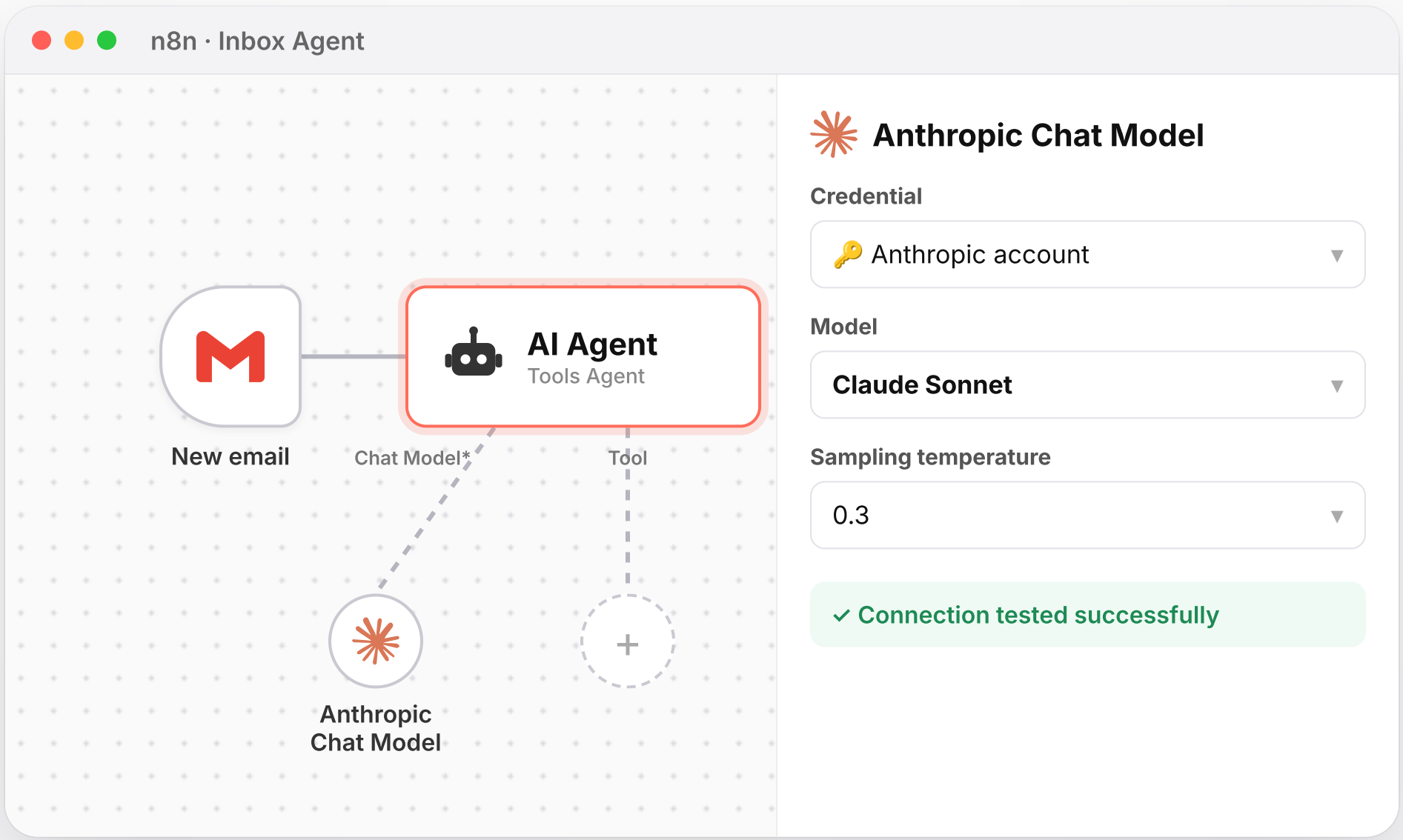


every new enquiry = one run

Step 3

Add the AI Agent + Connect Claude

Drop in an **AI Agent** node and plug Claude in as its brain.



Claude = the brain 🧠

Step 4

Write Its Instructions

Plain English. Tell it **what to do**, step by step, and what never to do.

System Message

AI Agent › Options › System Message

Expression

```
You are the inbox assistant for a small business.

For every new email:
1. Classify it: booking, quote, support or spam.
2. Booking? Check Google Calendar and offer 2 free slots.
3. Draft a short, friendly reply in the sender's language.
4. Log name, email and intent in Google Sheets.

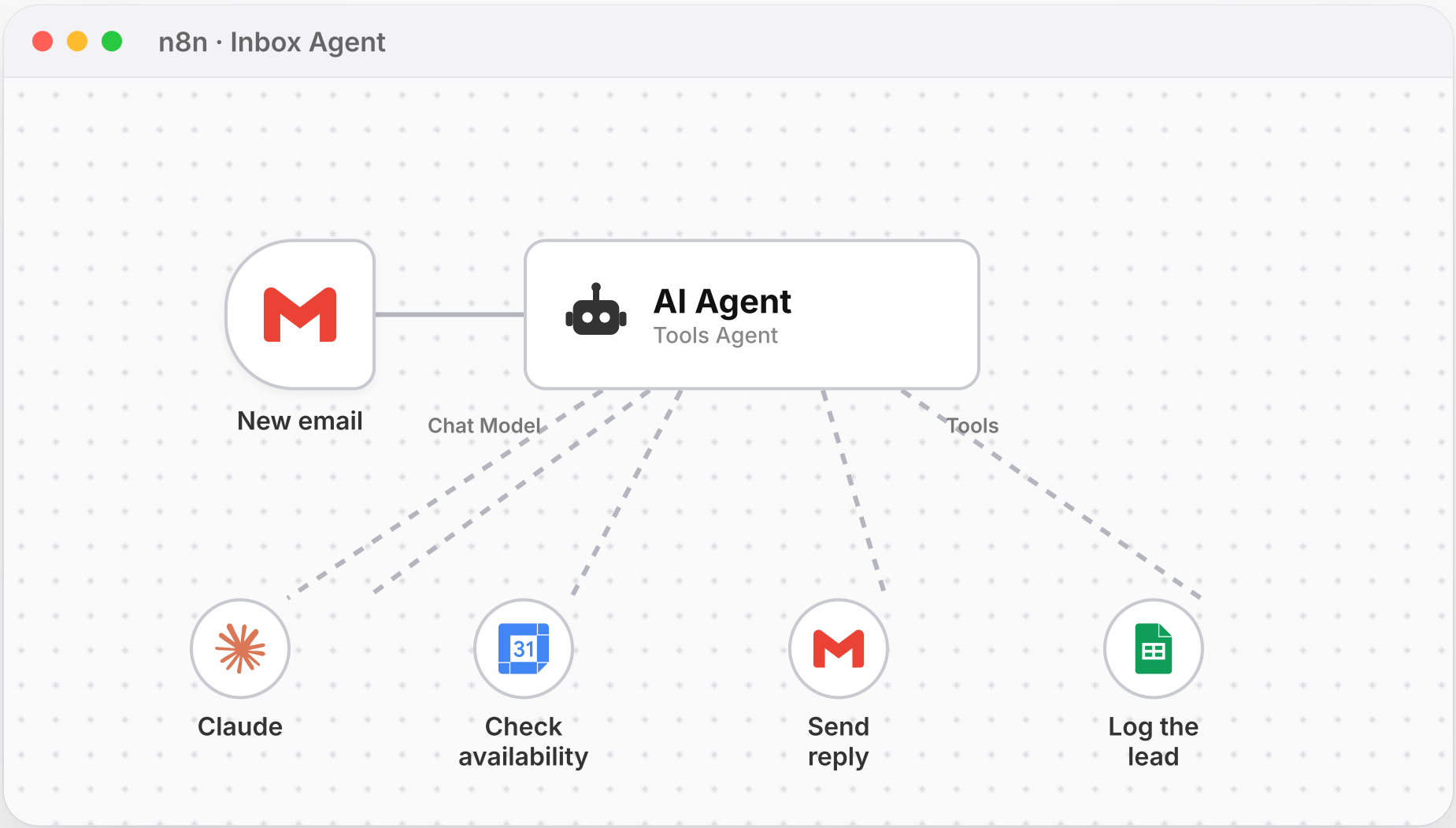
Never promise prices. If unsure, alert the owner on Slack.
```

guardrails matter

Step 5

Give It Tools

Tools are what turn a chatbot into an **agent**. It picks which one to use.



Calendar
finds free slots

Gmail
sends the reply

Sheets
saves every lead

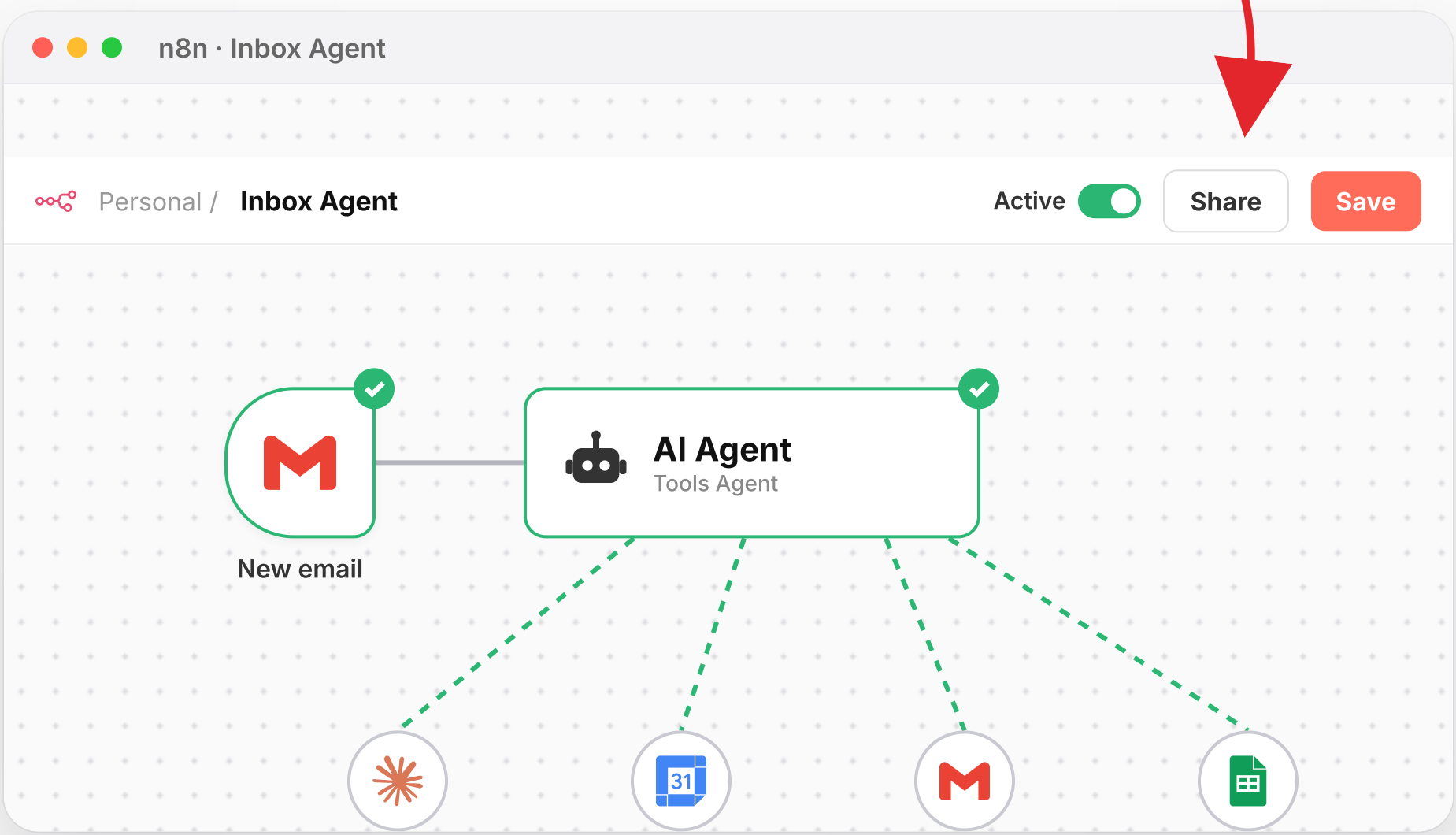
Slack
pings you if unsure

Step 6

Test It, Then Activate

Send yourself a test email. All green? Flip the switch to **Active**.

it's live!




```
✓ Email from Priya: "Can we meet this week?"
✓ Intent: booking · Free: Tue 4 PM, Thu 11 AM
✓ Reply sent · Lead saved to row 48
Succeeded in 6.2s · example run
```

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